

Jacoby Two Notrump

A 2NT response to a Major sit opening promises at least 4-card support and at least opening hand strength. It is absolutely forcing to game.

Opener's second bid describes her hand further:

4 of the Major shows a minimum featureless hand

3NT shows extra strength and a 5-card trump suit

3 of the Major shows extra strength and a 6+ card trump suit

3 of any other suit shows shortness (singleton or void)

4 of any other suit shows a second 5-card suit

Splinter Bids

A double-jump-shift as a response to partner's opening 1 of a Major suit is a Splinter bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least four card support for the Major, and a singleton or void in the "splintered" suit. It is absolutely forcing to game.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 5 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥ 3

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦ K

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6 ♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣ K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 7 ♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥ K

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6 ♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦ 2

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6 ♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦ 10

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7
 ♥ 9 6 5
 ♦ J 10 8 6
 ♣ A 8 7 6 4

♠ K Q 9 5 4

♥ A Q 8

♦ Q 9 7

♣ Q J



♠ A 2
 ♥ 10 4 3 2
 ♦ 5 4 2
 ♣ 10 9 3 2

♠ J 10 8 6 3

♥ K J 7

♦ A K 3

♣ K 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	4 ♦
Pass	4 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	5 ♠
All Pass			

5 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ 3

NORTH bids 3NT to show a good hand with five ♠s.

SOUTH shows his ♦ control, and NORTH then shows her ♥ control.

A final check with Blackwood shows two Aces missing. Too bad.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 9 6
 ♥ K Q 9 8
 ♦ Q 9 4
 ♣ A 5

♠ 10 4

♥ J 7

♦ 10 8 5 3

♣ J 7 6 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 8 7 5 2

♥ A 3

♦ J 6 2

♣ K Q

♠ 3

♥ 10 6 5 4 2

♦ A K 7

♣ 10 9 8 3

EAST shows his 6-card ♠ suit by bidding 3♠.

WEST shows her ♣ control and EAST shows his ♥ control, but it seems neither has a control in ♦s.

So they stop in game.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♣

Pass

4 ♥

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♦ K

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7
 ♥ 10 2
 ♦ J 10 8 4 2
 ♣ A K 10 4

♠ K J 8 4
 ♥ A K 9 4 3
 ♦ A 9 6
 ♣ 7



♠ 5 2
 ♥ 8 6
 ♦ 7 5 3
 ♣ 9 8 6 5 3 2

♠ A Q 9 6 3
 ♥ Q J 7 5
 ♦ K Q
 ♣ Q J

SOUTH might just use Jacoby 2NT since he has great ♥ support and more than 13 points. But, he has so much more than 13 points that he should inform partner by making a jump-shift. He plans to return to ♥s later.

NORTH has different plans. Knowing partner has five ♠s and 17 or more points she pushes straight to the ♠ slam.

It didn't matter, slam is cold in either Major.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♦
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 8 6

♥ 8 5

♦ 3

♣ A Q 9 6 3

♠ 10 5

♥ K Q 9

♦ Q J 9 6 5

♣ J 10 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ A K 8 2

♣ K 8

♠ 4 2

♥ J 10 7 6 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ 7 5 4

West

1 ♠

4 ♣

5 ♥

All Pass

7 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥K

North

Pass

Pass

Pass

East

2NT

4NT

7 ♠

South

Pass

Pass

EAST might jump-shift, but with no 5-card suit prefers to use Jacoby 2NT.

WEST shows some extra strength plus a 5-card ♣ suit with his 4♣ bid.

When EAST's Blackwood discovers two Aces in WEST's hand she goes right to 7♠. She knows WEST has only three red cards and her ♥A ♦AK will take care of them. She figures WEST can ruff out any ♣ losers.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 6 3
♥ 8 5
♦ J 10 6
♣ K Q 10 7 3

♠ A 9 5
♥ K Q J 7 2
♦ A Q
♣ 9 6 4



♠ 10 8 4 2
♥ 6 4
♦ 9 3 2
♣ A J 5 2

♠ K Q J
♥ A 10 9 3
♦ K 8 7 5 4
♣ 8

SOUTH bids 4♣, showing ♥ support, 13+ points and a singleton or void in ♣s.

NORTH first shows her ♦ A, then, when SOUTH signs off, makes one more try by showing her ♠ A.

SOUTH finally gets inspired and bids the slam.

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♦	Pass	4♥
Pass	4♠	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			
Lead: ♦ 2			

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 5 3

♥ A 6

♦ K J 7 2

♣ 8 7 4

♠ 8 4

♥ 9 4

♦ Q 6 5

♣ A K 10 9 6 2



♠ K Q 9 7 6 2

♥ K Q J 2

♦ A 8

♣ 5

♠ 10

♥ 10 8 7 5 3

♦ 10 9 4 3

♣ Q J 3

WEST has a very minimum 2NT bid, but when EAST shows ♣ shortness she can Control-bid her ♥A without showing extra values.

EAST's hand became huge when he heard about WEST's ♥A. When Blackwood shows they hold three Aces he bids what he expects to be a comfortable slam.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3 ♣

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5 ♥

Pass

6 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by East

Lead: ♦ 10